# Margaret Rivera

78 years · female · fictional demo patient

PERIOD Sep 19 – Oct 18, 2026 (30 days) | PREPARED BY Alex (daughter) | DATE October 18, 2026

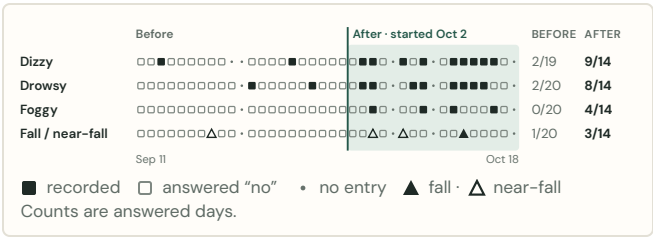
**Conditions (family-reported):** high blood pressure, type 2 diabetes, bladder leakage (urinary incontinence), insomnia, osteoarthritis

**AT A GLANCE** **Since Lorazepam (Ativan) was started (Oct 2): dizziness on 9 of 14 answered days, vs 2 of 19 before.**

## 1 WHY WE'RE COMING IN

Alex (daughter) wrote on Oct 11: "Mom seems foggier in the mornings since urgent care started the new sleeping pill. She almost fell in the bathroom on Wednesday."

## 2 WHAT WE'VE NOTICED




- Dizziness was recorded on 9 of 14 answered days from Oct 2, when Lorazepam (Ativan) was started, through Oct 18, compared with 2 of 19 answered days in the 21 days before. *In her words (Oct 7): "the room was spinning"*
- Daytime drowsiness was recorded on 8 of 14 answered days from Oct 2, when Lorazepam (Ativan) was started, through Oct 18, compared with 2 of 20 answered days in the 21 days before.
- Confusion or memory fog was recorded on 4 of 14 answered days from Oct 2, when Lorazepam (Ativan) was started, through Oct 18, compared with 0 of 20 answered days in the 21 days before.
- Also recorded around the time Lorazepam (Ativan) was started: sleep quality ratings averaged 3.4 out of 5 on 14 answered days after, compared with 2.6 out of 5 on 20 answered days before.
- Around the start of Lorazepam (Ativan) on Oct 2, check-ins were recorded on 20 of 21 days before (Sep 11 through Oct 1) and on 14 of 17 days after (Oct 2 through Oct 18).
- From Oct 2, when Lorazepam (Ativan) was started, through Oct 18: 1 fall (Oct 13) and 2 near-falls (Oct 4, Oct 7) were recorded on 14 answered days, compared with 1 near-fall (Sep 18) on 20 answered days in the 21 days before. *In her words (Oct 13): "Took a tumble"*

## 3 MEDICATION REVIEW PROMPTS

- Lorazepam (Ativan): benzodiazepine. AGS Beers 2023 lists Lorazepam (Ativan) as a medicine older adults should generally avoid. (AGS Beers Criteria® 2023)
- Tylenol PM (OTC): sedating (first-generation) antihistamine. AGS Beers 2023 lists the diphenhydramine in Tylenol PM (OTC) as a medicine older adults should generally avoid. (AGS Beers Criteria® 2023)
- Anticholinergic burden score (ACB): 7. Margaret's medicines add up to 7 on the Anticholinergic Cognitive Burden (ACB) scale, a published list of medicines with anticholinergic effects: the diphenhydramine in Tylenol PM (OTC) 3, Oxybutynin 3 and Furosemide (Lasix) 1. (ACB scale, 2012 update)
- Medicines linked to falls, with falls or dizziness recorded (5). 5 of Margaret's medicines are on published lists of medicines linked to falls in older adults (CDC STEADI-Rx and STOPPFall 2021): Lorazepam (Ativan), Furosemide (Lasix), Amlodipine, Tylenol PM (OTC) and Oxybutynin. (CDC STEADI-Rx; STOPPFall 2021)
- Possible prescribing cascade: Amlodipine → ankle swelling → Furosemide (Lasix). Furosemide (Lasix) was started on Jul 15, 45 days after Amlodipine, for "ankle swelling". (Savage 2020)

## 4 OUR QUESTIONS

1. Could Lorazepam (Ativan) be contributing to the dizziness, daytime drowsiness, confusion or memory fog, falls and near-falls recorded in the diary since Oct 2? Is Lorazepam (Ativan) still the best option for sleep or anxiety, and are there alternatives with less effect on balance and memory?
2. Could Tylenol PM (OTC) be contributing to the dizziness, daytime drowsiness, confusion or memory fog, falls and near-falls recorded in the diary in the last 30 days? Is the sedating antihistamine in Tylenol PM (OTC) still needed, or is there a gentler option for sleep or allergies?
3. Margaret's anticholinergic burden score (ACB) adds up to 7. Could any of these medicines be reduced or replaced with one that has less anticholinergic effect?
4. With 1 fall and 2 near-falls on 26 answered days, and dizziness on 10 of 25 answered days in the last 30 days, could any of these medicines be contributing, and could the list be reviewed for fall risk? Could Margaret's blood pressure be checked lying and standing (CDC STEADI)?

## 5 CURRENT MEDICATION LIST (8)

| MEDICINE · HOW TAKEN | FOR | PRESCRIBER | STARTED | REVIEW FLAGS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Amlodipine** · 10 mg once daily | Blood pressure | Dr. Okafor (cardiology) | May 31 | Fall risk · **Cascade?** |
| **Furosemide (Lasix)** · 20 mg once daily | Ankle swelling | Dr. Lee (primary care) | Jul 15 | **Beers caution** · **ACB 1** · Fall risk · **Cascade?** |
| **Metformin** · 500 mg twice daily | Diabetes | Dr. Lee (primary care) | May 1, 2024 | — |
| **Atorvastatin** · 20 mg nightly | Cholesterol | Dr. Lee (primary care) | May 1, 2024 | — |
| **Omeprazole** · 20 mg once daily | Heartburn | Dr. Lee (primary care) | Sep 13, 2025 | Beers avoid |
| **Oxybutynin** · 5 mg twice daily | Bladder | Dr. Shah (urology) | Mar 22 | **Beers condition + combo** · **ACB 3** · Fall risk |
| **Tylenol PM (OTC) (acetaminophen + diphenhydramine)** · 2 caplets at bedtime as needed | Sleep | Self-selected (over the counter) | Apr 21 | Beers avoid + condition + combo · **ACB 3** · Fall risk |
| **Lorazepam (Ativan)** NEW · 0.5 mg at bedtime | Anxiety / sleep | Urgent care | Oct 2 | Beers avoid + condition · Fall risk |

Flags: AGS Beers Criteria® 2023 · ACB = anticholinergic burden (1–3) · fall-risk lists (STEADI-Rx, STOPPFall) · cascade = possible prescribing cascade. Allergies are not recorded.

## 6 DIARY COVERAGE & LIMITATIONS

Check-ins were recorded on 26 of 30 days from Sep 19 through Oct 18; days without a check-in are left out of every count.

Doses taken are not logged, so as-needed medicines cannot be separated.

Recorded symptoms can change for many reasons, including chance and expectation; this record does not show cause. A real change can go unflagged.

This review checks published criteria (AGS Beers 2023, ACB scale, fall-risk medicines, known prescribing cascades). It does not check doses, kidney function unless provided, allergies, or every interaction. No flag is not an all-clear for any medicine.

Prepared by family from home records; not a clinical assessment.

**Don't stop or change any medicine without talking to the prescriber. If something feels like an emergency, call 911.**

Written by Kinwise's template (no AI) from 48 evidence records. Knowledge base 2026.10.2 · evidence 106370b4 · Reviewed by Alex on Oct 18, 2026, 10:30 AM. Fictional demo data.